



BRÜTAL
LEGEND

SKOAR! Special

more powerful units will only become available after you upgrade your Stage. To purchase upgrades and recruit units, you'll need to spend Fan Tributes that can be acquired by building a Merch Booth (merchandise booth) on top of Fan Geysers. Hence, having more Merch Booths than your opponent becomes essential a part of your winning strategy.

For most part, Eddie will play a more indirect role in this type of battle by issuing commands and buffing his own units or de-buffing enemy units. He can also team up with any of the available units to unleash some special attacks. If the enemy units get too close to your Stage, a last line of defence is available in the form of speakers and spot-lights.

NOTHING ELSE MATTERS

In terms of game-play, Brütal Legend does not offer anything revolutionary. What it does well is combine some of the tried-and-tested elements from other games to a generally satisfying effect. The game has a brilliantly funny script that we all have come to expect from Tim Schafer, which is further supported by some solid voice acting from the likes of Rob Halford, Lita Ford, Tim Curry and David Cross, among others.

Most notable of the lot is voice acting by Ozzy Osbourne with his signature broody voice and the work of self-styled messiah of Rock 'n' Roll, Jack Black—who has given the voice to the game's protagonist. The game serves its intended audience of Metal fans well, featuring a track list that can be envy of any music game. Consisting of over 100 tracks by over 70 different bands, the track list reads like a Who is Who of Metal Legends, along with some lesser known cult classic and some original composition for good measure.

HARD AS A ROCK

Like all the other games out there, Brütal Legend also has some flaws—most of them minor and none that are game breaking. For one, some people may find the main campaign a little short spanning over six

to seven hours. Additionally, like with most open-world games, the side mission can get a bit repetitive. For me however, the biggest gripe was the control and camera system, particularly during the Stage Battles.

Issuing commands to your units (especially individual commands) during the heat of the battle can be a bit difficult and may take a bit of practice to master. To that effect, the game does offer you an option to practice your Stage Battle skills with the game's A.I before you challenge others in the unforgiving world of online multiplayer gaming.

All in all this is one solid game and a must have for all music fans, especially Heavy Metal. For others, there is the prospect of exploring a well-crafted game world with unique art style. If none of these tickle your fancy, then you can count on the game's script that ensures there is never a dull moment.

THE SKOAR

Graphics.....7	8
Sound10	
Gameplay6	
Mojo9	